

AWE AWARDS 2026

Nomination & Voting Platform — Final Plan, Ready for Build

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1. Brand & Color System

Extracted directly from the AWE / Adwizers logo. These carry through the applicant form, admin dashboard, and voter portal for a consistent look.

Color	Hex	Used For
Royal Purple	#33004A	Headers, dashboard nav, primary backgrounds
Royal Magenta	#C2006E	CTAs — Vote buttons, links, highlights
Champagne Gold	#C68F45	Accents, borders, winner badges, dividers
Charcoal	#2A2A2A	Body text
White	#FFFFFF	Page backgrounds, card surfaces

2. System Overview

Three connected surfaces, all controlled from one unified Admin Dashboard — no separate tools or logins:

- Registration Form (public) → every submission lands in the dashboard as an Applicant
- Admin Dashboard (internal) → review, edit, approve payment, promote to Nominee, control voting, view results, export data
- Voter Portal (public) → category voting pages, each with its own shareable link, showing every nominee in that category

3. Registration Form → What Gets Stored

Maps directly to your Form 1, question by question:

#	Field	Stored As
1	Full Name	Text — required
2	WhatsApp Number	Phone — required, used as applicant contact ID
★	Email Address (New)	Text — required, added so nominees can be notified by email
3	Area / Location	Text — required
4	Business / Brand Name	Text — required
5	Business / Profession	Text — required
6	Business Category	Dropdown — 14 fixed options + Other (this becomes the award category)
7	Years in Business	Text / number
8	Business Journey (short)	Long text
9	Proudest Achievement	Long text
10	Social Links (IG / FB / Website / WhatsApp)	Text / URL

#	Field	Stored As
11	Logo / Product Photo	File upload → stored in Supabase Storage
12	Interested in Nomination?	Single-select — Yes / Maybe
13	Want WhatsApp Updates?	Yes / No
14	Nomination Declaration	Checkbox, required — stored with timestamp
15	Terms & Conditions	Checkbox, required — stored with timestamp
16	Communication Consent	Checkbox, optional
Resolved Email Address has been added to Form 1. Nominee selection notifications will be sent to this address automatically the moment an applicant is promoted to Nominee, via Resend — free tier covers 3,000 emails/month (100/day), comfortably enough for nominee notifications at this scale. Note the 100/day cap: promoting a very large batch of nominees in a single sitting could brush against it.		

4. Applicant → Nominee Workflow

- Applicant submits Form 1 → appears in Applicants list, status: New
- Admin reviews and can edit any field directly
- Admin collects payment offline, marks status: Payment Received
- Admin clicks “Promote to Nominee” → creates a linked Nominee profile, which appears as a card on that category's shared voting page
- The moment the nominee is published, an automatic email notification fires to the address collected on Form 1
- Nominee profile has its own edit screen, separate from the original Applicant submission — admin can polish public-facing copy, photo, and category without touching the original form data

5. Admin Dashboard Modules

Module	What It Does
Applicants	Every Form 1 submission lands here. Admin can view, edit any field, add internal notes, and mark payment received.
Nominees	Applicants promoted to nominee status. Admin edits the public-facing profile (photo, bio, category) separately from the original submission, publishes/unpublishes. Nominees carry no link of their own — they appear as cards on their category's shared voting page.
Categories	Create, edit, and reorder award categories used across the voting portal. Each category has its own unique shareable voting link — this is the link that actually gets shared.
Voting Control	Set voting start/end date-time, pause/resume, and view live status per category.
Analytics	Total nominees, total votes, total categories, total unique voters, votes-by-category chart. Admin-only — never exposed publicly.
Results / Winners	Preview and publish the Top-5-per-category Winner Reveal page once voting closes.
Export	Download Applicants, Nominees, and Vote data as CSV or Excel, any time.
Settings	Voting rules, security thresholds, manual backup trigger.

6. Voter Portal & Voting Flow

- Category Voting Page — one unique shareable link per category (not per nominee). Shows every nominee in that category as a card: photo, name, business name, short bio, with a checkbox on each

- Voter checks one or more nominees they want to vote for on that same page — no need to visit separate pages or links per nominee
- Voter fills the form once — Name, Mobile Number, Email, Location — covering every nominee they've checked
- CAPTCHA (Cloudflare Turnstile) runs invisibly in the background
- Email verification — a 6-digit code is sent to the email entered, via Amazon SES; voter enters it once to verify and unlock voting for the session (Section 8 has the full sequence)
- Voter hits Vote — one submission covers every nominee checked. Each is recorded independently against the duplicate-vote layers (Section 8): nominees not yet voted for get a vote recorded, any already voted for are skipped and flagged back to the voter
- Confirmation shows a Vote ID receipt for each nominee successfully voted, plus a note for any that were already voted for (e.g. “3 votes recorded, 2 already voted for”)

7. Updated Voting Rule

Changed from “one vote per category” to a nominee-level rule:

- **A voter may vote for several different nominees within the same category**
- **But only once per individual nominee**
- Enforced as a database rule checked against the layers in Section 8: mobile number, email, and device ID — not per category

Example: in a 5-nominee category, the same voter can check and vote for up to all 5 nominees in one submission — one vote each. If they come back later and check a nominee they already voted for, that one is skipped while any new selections still go through.

8. Duplicate-Vote & Fraud Prevention — Working Plan

Two different problems, two different tools — splitting them out instead of treating it as one layer.

Vote Submission Sequence

- Page loads on the category's shared link — Cloudflare Turnstile loads invisibly in the background. First visit generates a random Device ID (localStorage + cookie); return visits reuse it
- Voter checks one or more nominees on the category page, fills Name, Mobile Number, Email, Location once, submits
- Rate-limit check (server, first, cheapest) — too many votes too fast from this IP/device is rejected immediately, before anything else runs
- Turnstile check (server) — the token is verified directly with Cloudflare; missing or invalid token rejects the whole submission here, before any email is sent or database touched
- Email verification (session-based) — if this email hasn't been verified yet this visit, a 6-digit code is sent via Amazon SES; voter enters it once to unlock voting for the rest of the session (30–60 minutes) — no code needed again for further votes in that window, even across different nominees or categories
- Save attempt — one vote row is written per checked nominee, each checked independently against the database rules below. This is not all-or-nothing: nominees that pass get recorded, nominees that clash get skipped, in the same submission
- Response — voter sees a summary: which nominees got a vote recorded, and which were already voted for (“You've already voted for this nominee”) — skipped attempts are logged (which signal matched, which nominee) for the admin dashboard
- On success — a Vote ID receipt is generated per nominee successfully voted, shown together in one confirmation

Why the Database Does the Real Duplicate-Checking

A “check, then insert” done as two separate app steps has a real gap: two votes arriving at nearly the same instant can both pass the check before either one saves. Putting the uniqueness rule directly on the database table closes that gap completely — the database refuses the second insert no matter how close together the requests land.

Signal	Database Rule
Mobile Number	One vote per nominee — self-declared

Signal	Database Rule
Email Address	One vote per nominee — verified by one-time code
Device ID	One vote per nominee — self-declared (client-side)

Three separate rules on the same votes table, all scoped to the nominee. Whichever one clashes first blocks the insert automatically — no race condition possible.

Cost note: because verification is once per session rather than once per vote, the number of codes sent tracks unique visiting sessions, not total votes — realistically a fraction of the total vote count. At Amazon SES's ₹0.10-per-1,000-email rate, even 50,000 codes sent would run about ₹425, and it's likely covered entirely by AWS's \$200 new-account credit.

Two providers, deliberately: Resend handles nominee notifications (Section 3) — low volume, occasional, and Resend's free tier is a comfortable fit. Amazon SES handles voter verification codes here — potentially tens of thousands during a live voting window, where SES's cheap per-email metered rate fits better than Resend's tiered plan structure would.

Turnstile Setup

- Free Cloudflare account → Turnstile → add a site → get a Site Key (public, goes on the vote page) and a Secret Key (private, server-only, never shipped to the browser)
- Site Key renders the challenge on the vote page — invisible for most real visitors
- Every submission carries a one-time token from that challenge
- Server checks that token with Cloudflare before accepting the vote — a missing, fake, or reused token is rejected outright

Rate Limits

Scope	Limit	Why
Per IP	3 votes / minute	Blunts scripted bursts, tolerates normal shared wifi
Per device	20 votes / hour	Covers one real voter across several categories, still tight enough to stop flooding

Worth knowing

Email is now genuinely verified (one-time code, not just matched) — that closes the junk/typo-email gap and adds real friction against casual repeat voting. Mobile and Device ID stay self-declared/client-side, same as before.

Even verified, email doesn't fully solve deliberate multi-voting on its own — a determined person can still create and verify several different real inboxes. It raises the bar meaningfully (each one takes a working inbox and an extra step), it just isn't a single-identity guarantee the way phone OTP would be.

CAPTCHA and rate limiting are what actually stop large-scale abuse, since a script can generate infinite fake numbers, emails, and device IDs as easily as a real fraud attempt can.

Together, this combination meaningfully cuts down both the automated and the casual-human version of duplicate voting — the realistic risk for a community awards vote at this scale. It is not a hard, unbeatable lock — that only exists with paid phone verification, which is intentionally out of scope here.

On the admin side: votes that trip a match aren't just silently blocked — they're logged, so the dashboard can surface patterns like “3 attempts on this nominee from the same device with different numbers” for manual review.

9. Anti-Fraud & Basic Security

- CAPTCHA (Cloudflare Turnstile) on every vote submission (Section 8)
- Rate limiting per device and per IP (Section 8)
- Three-layer duplicate detection on every vote — mobile, email, device ID (Section 8)
- Vote counts hidden at the database level (Row Level Security) — not just hidden in the UI, so there's no public API route that leaks them either
- Blocked/flagged vote attempts logged for admin review, not silently discarded

10. Voting Control

- Admin sets a Voting Start and End date-time
- Voting auto-locks the moment the end time hits — shows “Voting Closed” automatically

- Manual Pause/Resume toggle, independent of the scheduled timer, for handling issues mid-window

11. Results & Winner Reveal Page

- Vote counts stay completely hidden — admin-only — for the entire voting period
- Once voting closes, admin can trigger a Reveal action to publish the Winner Result Page
- Shows Top 5 nominees per category publicly, only after admin publishes it — nothing is shown before that

12. Export & Reporting

CSV and Excel export, available to admin at any time, for: Applicants, Nominees, raw vote data, and category-wise vote summaries.

13. Database Backup

Reality check: Supabase's free tier does not include managed automatic backups — that's a paid-tier feature. The free-tier-compatible option is a scheduled export job (a free daily script) that dumps the database to a downloadable file for admin, at no extra cost. If the vote data becomes valuable enough to warrant managed point-in-time backups, that's a small paid upgrade we'd flag before enabling, not something bundled in by default.

14. Post-Launch Support

A defined bug-fixing/support window is included after launch to handle issues arising from this original scope — not open-ended, but enough to catch and fix real launch-week problems.

15. Award Categories — Confirmed

Locked as-is: all 14 raw Form 1 categories, no merging. Each gets its own category page and its own unique shareable voting link (Section 6).

#	Award Category (= Form 1 Option)
1	Home-Based Business
2	Makeup & Beauty
3	Hair & Styling
4	Mehndi & Aari Work
5	Baking & Food
6	Resin, Crafts & Gifts
7	Jewellery & Fashion
8	Boutique & Clothing
9	Digital Creator / Content Creator
10	Digital Marketing / Graphic Design
11	Online Yoga / Wellness
12	Tuition & Coaching
13	Handmade Products
14	Other

16. Decisions Locked for Build

- 14 award categories, unmerged, each with its own unique shareable voting link — no per-nominee links (Sections 6, 15)
- Voters select one or more nominees per category and submit in a single batch (Sections 6, 7, 8)
- CAPTCHA via Cloudflare Turnstile on every submission — free, unlimited (Section 8)
- Rate limiting: 3 votes/minute per IP, 20 votes/hour per device (Section 8)
- Email verified by one-time code (Amazon SES), session-based — once per visit, not once per vote (Section 8)
- Mobile Number and Device ID stay self-declared, checked alongside verified email — one vote per nominee per signal (Section 8)
- Nominee notifications via Resend; voter verification codes via Amazon SES (Sections 3, 8)
- Vote counts admin-only for the full voting period; Top-5-per-category reveal is a manual admin action after close (Section 11)